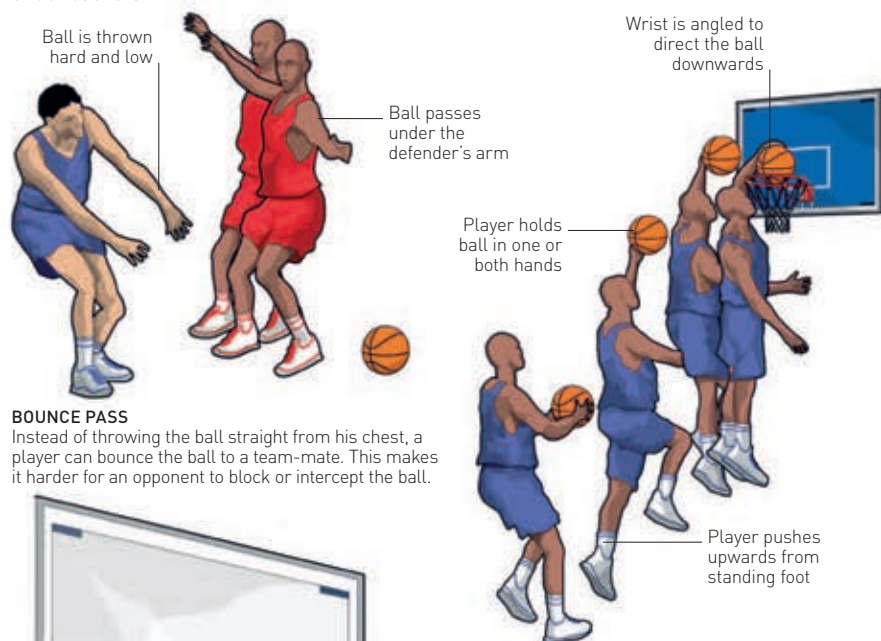


SKILLS AND TECHNIQUES

All basketball players need good ball-handling skills. To be successful, a team needs to be able to pass to each other, dribble, shield the ball from opponents, and, most importantly, shoot baskets.

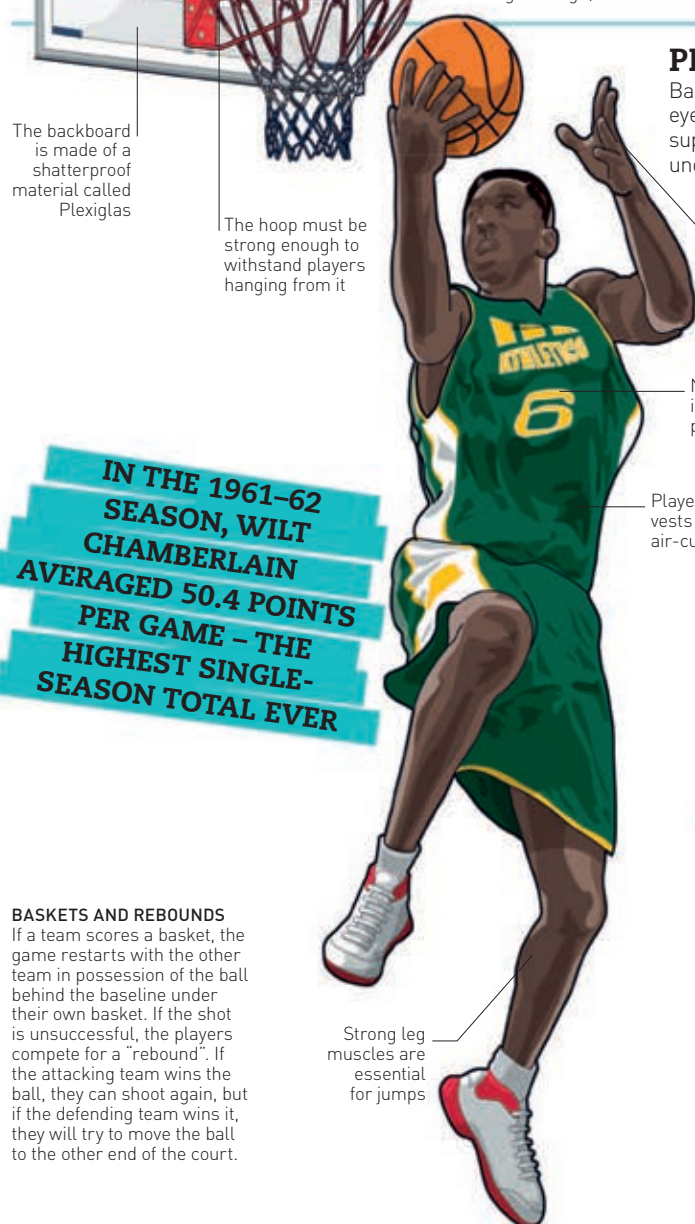


BOUNCE PASS

Instead of throwing the ball straight from his chest, a player can bounce the ball to a team-mate. This makes it harder for an opponent to block or intercept the ball.

SLAM DUNK

The player runs up, jumps very high, and, with one or two hands, aims the ball downwards into the basket. The slam dunk is a popular shot because, as long as the player can jump high enough, its success rate is high.

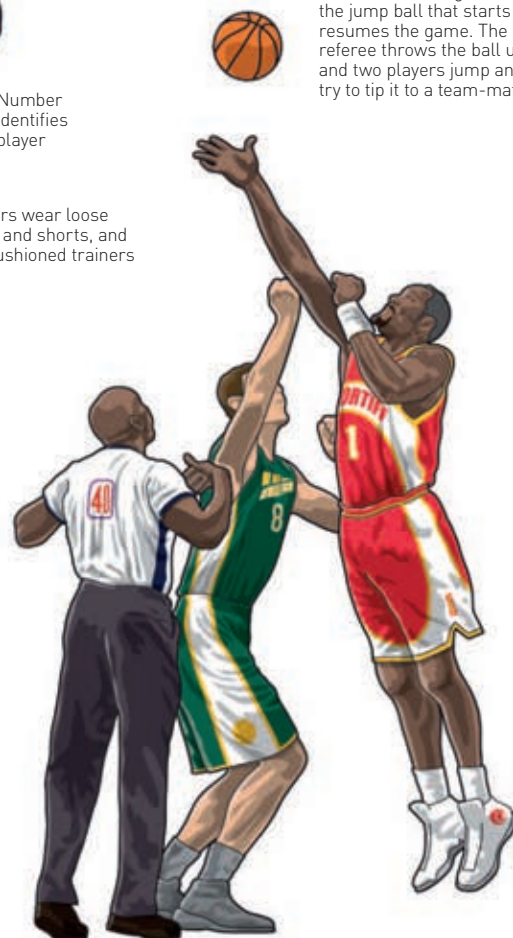


PLAYING THE GAME

Basketball players require great athleticism, excellent hand-eye coordination, and, because it is such a fast-paced game, superb stamina. They also need to be tall. Players are rarely under 1.8 m (6 ft) and are often as tall as 2.1 m (7 ft).

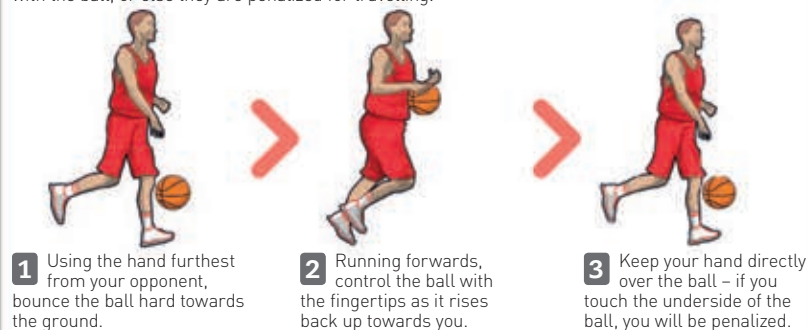
TIP-OFF

This is the name given to the jump ball that starts or resumes the game. The referee throws the ball up, and two players jump and try to tip it to a team-mate.



DRIBBLING

Dribbling is the name given to bouncing the ball continuously. A player must dribble while moving with the ball, or else they are penalized for travelling.



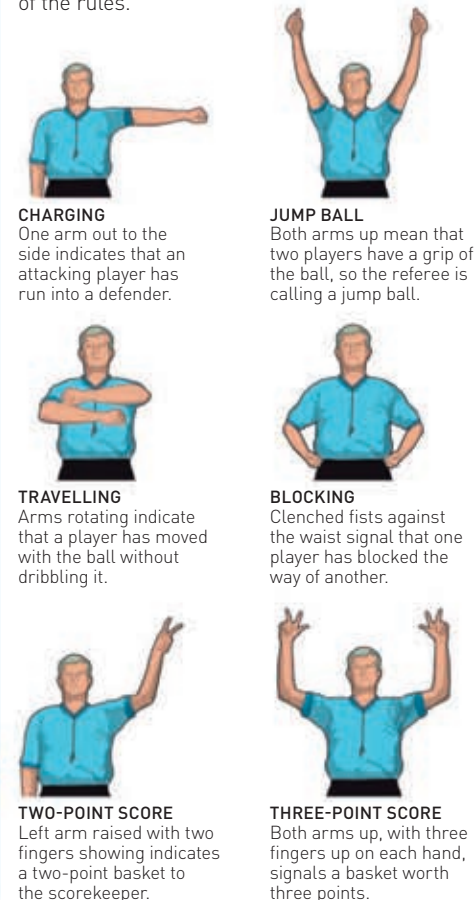
MOVING

Once a player has stopped dribbling, he or she is not allowed to dribble for a second time. Instead, the player must keep one foot on the ground and pivot (swivel) on it before shooting or passing.



OFFICIALS' SIGNALS

A team of officials oversees a game. The timekeeper starts the clock when the ball is in play and pauses it whenever play is stopped. The shot-clock operator makes sure that the team in possession shoots within a certain time. There are two referees, who make gestures and signals to indicate aspects of play and breaches of the rules.



BASKETS AND REBOUNDS

If a team scores a basket, the game restarts with the other team in possession of the ball behind the baseline under their own basket. If the shot is unsuccessful, the players compete for a "rebound". If the attacking team wins the ball, they can shoot again, but if the defending team wins it, they will try to move the ball to the other end of the court.

IN THE 1961-62 SEASON, WILT CHAMBERLAIN AVERAGED 50.4 POINTS PER GAME – THE HIGHEST SINGLE-SEASON TOTAL EVER